

Gunman thought he had football brain injury

Ex-high school player appeared to target NFL in Manhattan shooting

BY RICK MAESE, VIVIAN HO AND ALBERT SAMAHA

The man who opened fire in a Manhattan office building Monday carried a letter in which he speculated that he suffered from traumatic brain injury and blamed the National Football League for his struggles, authorities said Tuesday.

Police said Shane Tamura, a 27-year-old former high school football player, had a “documented mental health history” and appeared to be targeting the NFL when he opened fire, killing four people and injuring a fifth before turning the gun on himself.

In his handwritten letter, which law enforcement found in his wallet, the gunman said he believed he suffered from chronic traumatic encephalopathy, or CTE — a degenerative brain disease that can be diagnosed only posthumously — and pleaded, “Study my brain please.”

On the third page of the letter, Tamura apologized and said the NFL “knowingly concealed the dangers to our brains to maximize profits. They failed us,” according to a law enforcement official who spoke on the condition of anonymity because they were not authorized to discuss

SEE SHOOTING ON A4



Victims: Police officer Didarul Islam, left, an investment executive and a security guard were among the dead. **A4**



OMAR AL-QATTAA/AFP/GETTY IMAGES

Mourners carry the body of a Palestinian killed in an Israeli strike the night before, at a funeral in Gaza City on Tuesday.

More than 60,000 lives lost in Gaza

BY LOUISA LOVELUCK, GERRY SHIH, SIHAM SHAMALAKH AND MIRIAM BERGER

The number of Palestinians killed in the Israeli military campaign against Hamas in Gaza passed 60,000 on Tuesday, local health authorities said. It is a figure public health analysts, doctors and conflict casualty monitors say is likely to be a significant undercount, as Israel’s ground operations and attacks on hospitals have upended the enclave’s health care infrastructure.

The toll reported by the Gaza Health Ministry, which is run by Hamas and whose numbers are widely accepted by the United Nations and other international in-

Toll collated by enclave’s Health Ministry is likely to be an undercount

stitutions, includes combatants as well as civilians. The ministry does not distinguish between the two but says that more than half of those killed were women and children, an assertion supported by health systems experts, data scientists and an independent survey of mortality figures in Gaza cross-checked against the Health Ministry’s numbers.

The ministry has recently begun reporting a separate toll: the growing number of deaths from

hunger after months of Israeli aid restrictions raised the threat of mass starvation. More than 130 people have died of hunger, most of them in recent weeks, according to the Health Ministry. More than 1,000 have been shot waiting for aid, most in the scramble to reach first-come, first-served food distributed at points located inside Israeli military zones, including at least 14 people in central Gaza on Tuesday, according to the ministry.

Gaza as it was before the war — a tiny but bustling territory with high-rises, universities and seaside cafes — no longer exists. Entire cities have been reduced to rubble. The highways have been excoriated, exposing the sand beneath. Most of the population has

been pushed into the 12 percent of the enclave that Israel has not ordered evacuated, and diseases such as polio and meningitis have emerged.

“The scale of human suffering and the stripping of human dignity have long exceeded every acceptable standard — both legal and moral,” Mirjana Spoljaric, president of the International Committee of the Red Cross, said in a statement Friday. “Every political hesitation, every attempt at justification of the horrors being

SEE GAZA ON A9

Airdrops: Experts say they’re not an effective way to deliver aid. **A8**

18,500 children: The Post tracked names and stories of the dead. **A10**

Trump’s line on China shifts focus from security to trade

BY ELLEN NAKASHIMA AND NOAH ROBERTSON

The Trump administration has softened its approach to Beijing amid high-stakes trade talks this week and in advance of a potential fall summit between President Donald Trump and Chinese President Xi Jinping.

The moves include dissuading Taiwan’s leader from making planned stopovers in the United States next month, postponing a meeting between Taipei’s defense minister and top Pentagon leaders in June, and pausing new export controls on China, according to more than a dozen current

and former U.S. officials and other people familiar with the actions.

Critics of the nascent détente — including both Republicans and Democrats — have warned that the recent moves could undermine U.S. national security and impact regional alliances. Their concern is that Trump’s desire to strike a trade deal with China is sidelining administration efforts to more forcefully compete with Beijing economically, technologically and militarily.

China is aggressively seeking to displace the U.S. and its western

SEE CHINA ON A12

Tax experts warn IRS’s debt notices could be used to fire federal staff

BY JULIE ZAUZMER WEIL AND SHANNON NAJMABADI

The IRS has sent letters to federal workers alleging that they are among 525,000 current and former government staffers who owe back taxes, prompting tax experts to warn that the unpaid bills could be used as a pretext to fire them from their jobs.

The letters, mailed last month, begin with the words “Urgent: You have an outstanding tax issue,” in bold, large type.

They started arriving in peo-

ple’s mailboxes shortly after the Office of Personnel Management proposed a rule that would make it easier to dismiss employees who don’t meet certain “suitability criteria,” including “failure to comply with generally applicable legal obligations, including timely filing of tax returns.”

While privacy laws generally prevent the IRS from sharing information about individuals’ tax returns with other government agencies, several tax practitioners and employment lawyers

SEE WORKERS ON A14

At national parks, profound affection and deep concern

Visitors at four of America’s ‘crown jewels’ worry about what budget cuts mean for the future

BY KARIN BRULLIARD, KIM BELLWARE, KAREN MILLER PENSIERO AND MOLLY HENNESSY-FISKE

Weeks into summer, millions of tourists are again streaming by car, camper, boat and hiking boot to America’s national parks. The 63 sites, spanning deserts and peaks, swamps and beaches, are among the most visited and most revered spots on the continent, postcard-ready emblems of a vast country proud of its public lands and awe-inspiring scenery.

But the summer of 2025 is unlike any before. The National Park Service, like other federal agencies, has been hit hard by President Donald Trump’s government reorganization. Firings, early retirements and job freezes have diminished the long-underfunded system’s permanent employees by nearly a quarter, according to the National Parks Conservation Association. As of July, the advocacy group tallied, just over half of the target number of seasonal workers had been hired to help manage the crowds.

Ominous signs of the impact surfaced this spring. Some visitor centers and campgrounds were temporarily closed because of staffing shortages, as was Arches National Park’s famed Fiery Furnace trail in Utah; ranger-led tours



Glacier National Park, top left; Mammoth Cave National Park, top right; and Zion National Park, bottom left and right.

TOP LEFT: KARIN BRULLIARD/THE WASHINGTON POST; TOP RIGHT: KIM BELLWARE/THE WASHINGTON POST; BOTTOM LEFT AND RIGHT: MOLLY HENNESSY-FISKE/THE WASHINGTON POST

EPA aims to topple climate law pillar

GREENHOUSE GASES FINDING UNDER FIRE

Agency would ax opinion girding emissions rules

BY JAKE SPRING AND ANUSHA MATHUR

The Environmental Protection Agency on Tuesday unveiled a proposal to rescind the landmark legal opinion that underpins virtually all of its regulations to curb climate change.

The move would end EPA regulations on greenhouse gases emitted by vehicles from light-weight cars to heavy-duty trucks, while also undercutting rules that limit power plant emissions and control the release of methane by oil and gas companies. The EPA’s new proposal argues that Congress, in the Clean Air Act, does not give the agency the authority to regulate greenhouse gas emissions.

If the rule takes effect, it would immediately reverse the vehicle regulations and spark a legal battle that probably would take years.

Should the Trump administration prevail in court, the rule would severely limit the ability of future presidents to curb fossil fuel emissions.

“If finalized, today’s announcement would amount to the largest deregulatory action in the history of the United States,” EPA Administrator Lee Zeldin said Tuesday at a truck dealership in Indianapolis.

The EPA released what is known as the “endangerment finding” in 2009. It concluded that greenhouse gases endanger public health and welfare, establishing a

SEE CLIMATE ON A5

IN THE NEWS

Handling of Epstein files The Washington Post texted nearly 1,100 Americans about President Donald Trump and the federal investigation. Here’s what they said. **A18**

Ruling in Virginia fight Eight of Gov. Glenn Youngkin’s picks for public university boards can no longer serve in that capacity. **B13**

THE NATION **Susan Monarez**, a longtime government scientist, was confirmed as the new CDC chief. **A3** **The Pentagon** reversed its decision to end access to satellite data used to track hurricanes. **A5**

THE WORLD **Nearly 40 people** have been killed as heavy rains triggered flooding in China. **A12** **Russian strikes** killed dozens in Ukraine hours after Trump escalated his ceasefire push. **A12**

THE ECONOMY **The FDA** pushed to restrict 7-OH, a potent synthetic opioid created from a compound in the kratom leaf. **A13** **The global economy** is growing at a 3 percent rate, the International Monetary Fund said — faster than expected despite Trump’s tariffs. **A14**

STYLE **The autopen** has been a tool of convenience for many presidents. So why has Trump deemed its use a “SCANDAL”? **B1**

SPORTS **Eddie Goldman**, a D.C. native, joined the Commanders’ defense with a craving for stopping the run. **B7**

THE REGION **The D.C. Council’s** move to modify a law on tipped wages passed by voters in 2022 undermines the populace’s will, advocates say. **B13**

FOOD **As chains** do battle over the chicken wrap, here’s how eight of the best options stack up. **E1**

BUSINESS NEWS.....A13
COMICS.....B4
OBITUARIES.....B16
OPINION PAGES.....A15
TELEVISION.....B6
WORLD NEWS.....A8

CONTENT © 2025
The Washington Post
Year 148, No. 54293

